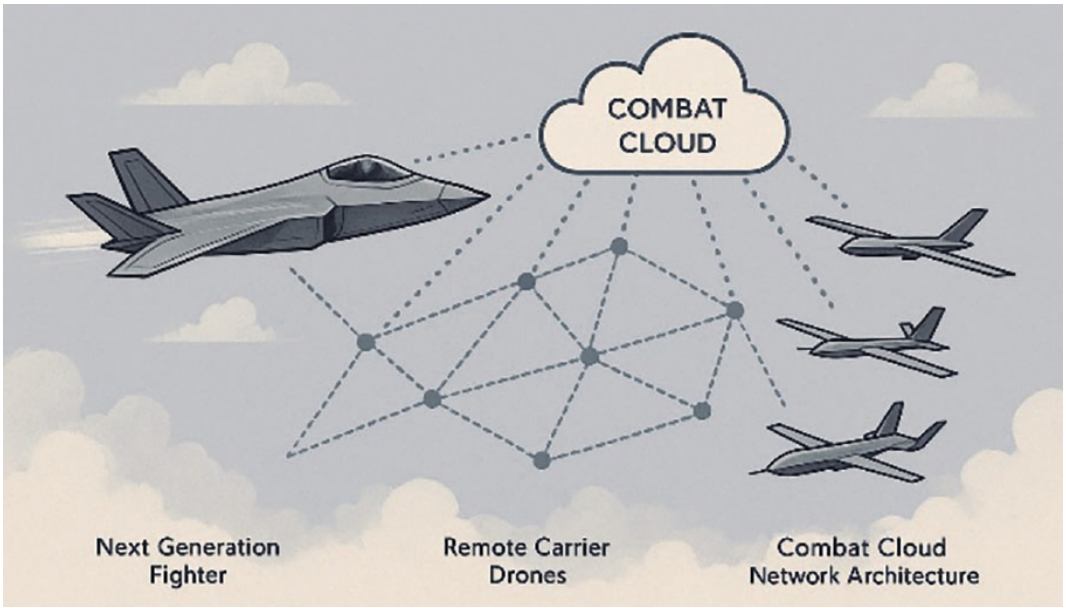


Figure 5.7 Future Combat Air System (FCAS), 2021.⏎

5.6.2.6 Tengden TW-356 (2020)

The Tengden TW-356, developed by Sichuan Tengden Technology Company (China) in 2020, is a large high-altitude long-endurance (HALE) unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) designed for multi-role operations including intelligence, surveillance, reconnaissance (ISR), logistics support, and electronic warfare (EW). It reflects China's strategic emphasis on autonomous heavylift UAVs capable of performing both military and civilian missions over extended durations and vast ranges.

Structurally, the TW-356 features a twin-boom configuration with a wide wingspan exceeding 40 meters, enabling high lift and endurance for sustained flight missions. Its composite airframe construction and efficient turboprop engines allow operations at altitudes above 30,000 feet with an endurance exceeding 40 hours. Designed with modularity in mind, the drone can carry multiple payloads, including radar, electro-optical systems, communication relays, or cargo pods, depending on the mission requirements.